



Active aging companion

The ElliQ is a new digital assistant from Israeli startup, Intuition Robotics designed for the elderly. <http://dgit.in/ElliQn>



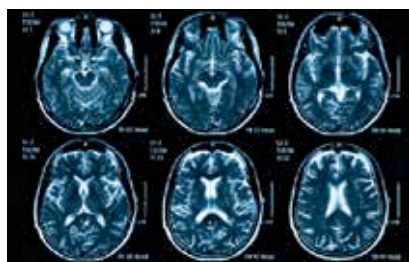
RIP Lily drone

The autonomous camera drone that raised more than \$34 million on Kickstarter is dead. Buyers demanding refunds. <http://dgit.in/RIPlily>

a patient. To do this, Watson would also get the help of the technology called deep learning with which it has been upgraded. Deep learning helps Watson to identify data patterns that contain huge chunks of information.

One example of diagnosis in this manner is with melanoma. Melanoma is a type of skin cancer that is quite difficult to spot. This is because it appears differently in different people. Combining deep learning and the wealth of medical images in its possession, Watson may recognize crucial features of the disease that were missed by the doctors to begin with.

For instance, if doctors feed the image of a recently diagnosed case of melanoma to Watson, the image would then be added to its database. This image could then be compared with literally thousands of other images. Once this information is compiled, doctors could gain from it an overview



Tech helps processing images-and diagnosis faster

of how to diagnose potential melanoma patients in the future.

The confidence in the change that the acquisition of Merge by IBM would bring in health care came through loud and clear when Michale W. Ferro Jr., the Chairman of Merge said that the "combination of assets" would deliver "unparalleled value" to the people. Judging by the way technology is being harnessed in novel ways for diagnosis, that may just be the case.

Piecing together the puzzle from genes

Diagnosis is the precursor to prescribing the right treatment. And like with many things in life, the art of diagnosis is also gaining in depth,

becoming more precise. In more prosaic terms, diagnosis is no more just about identifying the disease, it's also about identifying the minutiae of



In depth diagnosis with genetic profiling

the disease which could be different from people to people. Such a diagnosis would help doctors prescribe the most apt treatment for a particular patient. An accurate diagnosis of this depth, if made possible in a short time could be the difference between life and death.

Particularly true for such deadly diseases like cancer.

IBM's Watson comes into play on this regard too. The deep learning abilities of Watson enables it to translate a patient's DNA into a genetic profile which the physicians could use to pinpoint the issues the patient suffers from. This would in turn help the doctors to prescribe the most ideal treatment options for the patients.

To get to such a level of precision-diagnosis is no easy task. For a single individual's genome would take up around 100 gigabytes of memory. And analyzing this wide a range of information, not to mention the journals, studies, textbooks and health records would consume countless man hours. If doctors are freed from this task, they could tend to the patients more. Which is why Watson is such a powerful tool since it can perform the task in mere minutes of time.

In terms of bringing down the time required for such precision-diagnosis, many acknowledge that Watson is already doing a pretty good job, including Dr. Lukas Wartman, assistant director of cancer genomics at The McDonnell Genome Institute

in St. Louis, USA, one of the leading institutions in the field.

Having said that, it must also be added that Watson is still in its initial stages. It's said that the technology that would enable Watson to perform at its fullest potential is yet to come. Though technology is progressing at a more rapid pace than ever before, evolution of technology is still a time consuming process. This means that Watson isn't yet powerful enough to replace health care professionals but doing such things as processing billions of medical images and bringing down diagnosis time has already made it the doctor's ally, and the patient's new hope.

Using an old tool in new ways

Using something that's already in existence in novel—often unexpected—ways could also constitute useful innovation. And this mode of innovation, perhaps not surprisingly is seen more among startups than established firms. Being in the back seat when it comes to funds, it's often with creativity that startups fight the bigwigs.

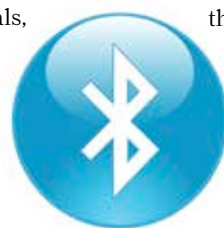
The American startup Intelomed is one such. And they have come up with something that's quietly changing healthcare for all.

The company's technology called CVInsight uses one of the most popular technologies of today—the humble Bluetooth to help doctors gain information about a patient's bodily parameters.

This information would then help them come up with the apt diagnosis for the patient's condition. The technology makes use of a single Bluetooth sensor that's worn on the forehead of the patient.

Not only would this help doctors collect crucial data for diagnosis, it would also help them monitor the patient live, helping them

act immediately in the event of some unfavorable changes in the patient's statistics. For the health care professional, this means that ambiguities in diagnosis can be cut down using precise data.



The good old Bluetooth, used in an all new way